



AUT

Working in New Zealand (International Students)

AUT Employability and Careers



Workshop Outline

- ☐ Understanding the NZ work culture
- ☐ What do NZ employers want
- ☐ Developing NZ networks
- ☐ Gaining NZ work experience
- ☐ Resources



Quiz: Kiwi slang!

Have a
conversation

Holiday house

Cool,
awesome
or no
problem

Asking
someone
'don't you
agree?'

Swimwear

Small shop
selling day-
to-day
essentials

Togs

Dairy

Yarn

Sweet
as

Bach

Ay



New Zealand Workplace Culture

New Zealand Businesses

Small

- NZ businesses are typically smaller & have fewer staff numbers (13 people on average compared to 32 in France)*

Flat structure

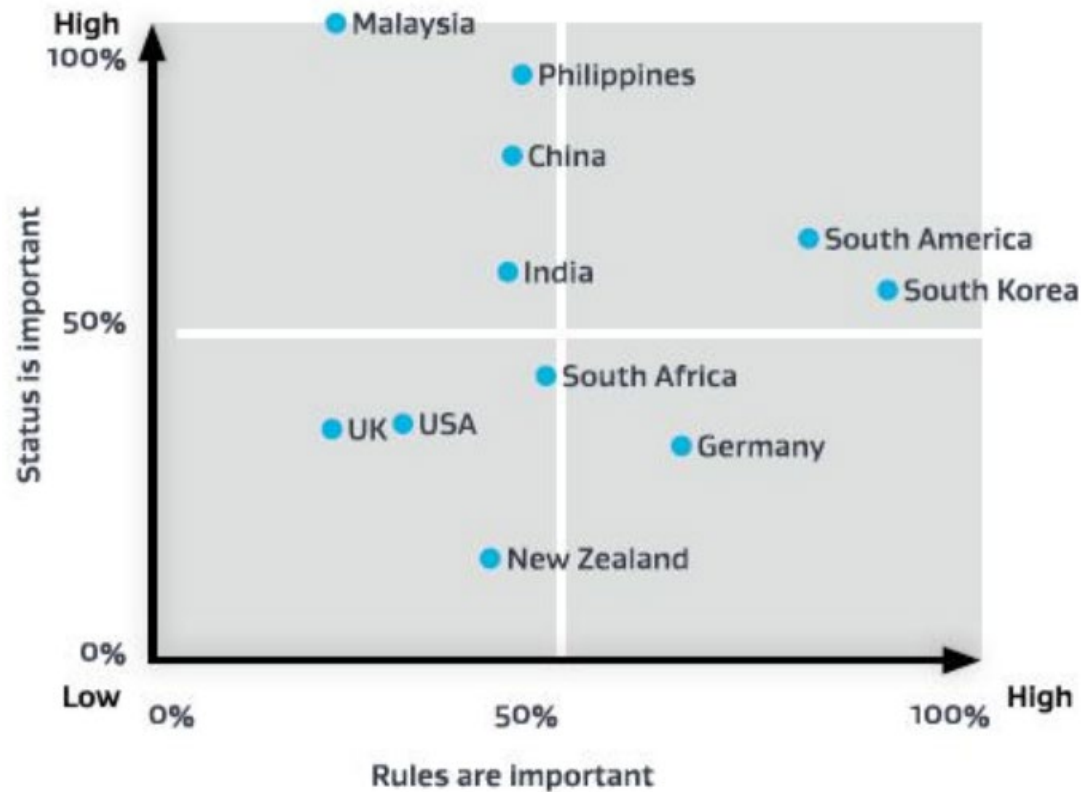
- Due to smaller staffing numbers the structure is often 'flat' rather than hierarchical

All-rounders

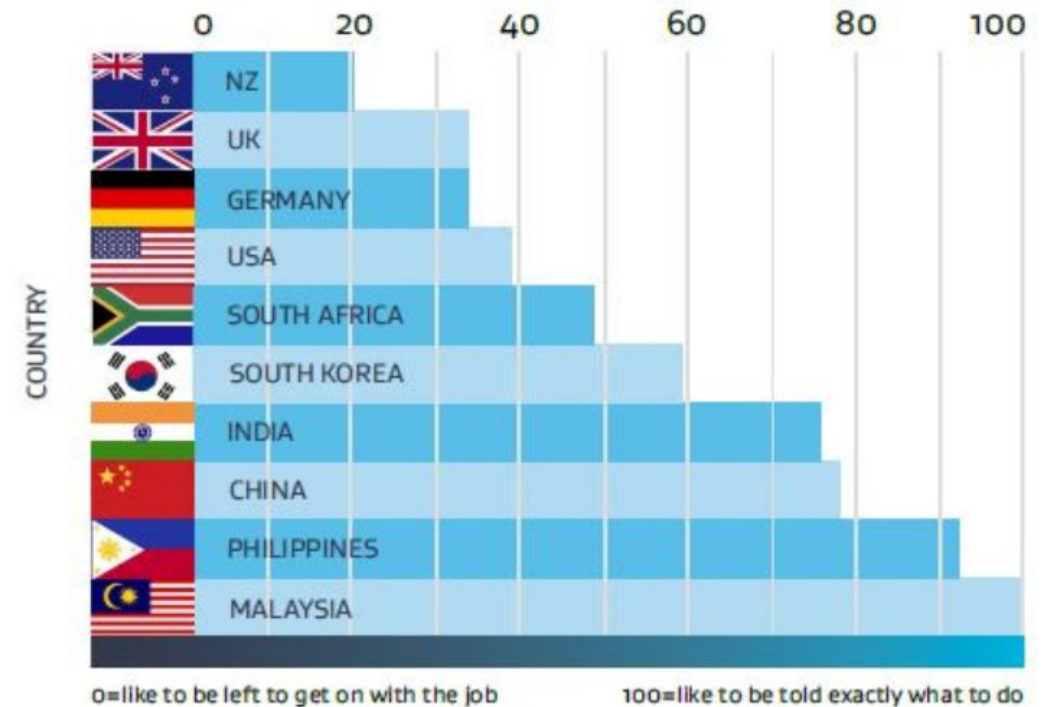
- Smaller staff numbers also mean that employees are often expected to work independently and as 'all-rounders' – a positive can-do attitude is highly regarded

Workplace culture in NZ

Cultural value differences



Cultural differences in management style preferences



Socialising at Work



- Because the teams in NZ workplaces are typically smaller, it's important that staff get on well
- Socialising in the kiwi workplace can take many forms such as morning teas, birthday celebrations, coffee or after work drinks
- These social events are an important way to build bonds and networks throughout the company you work for.

Source: <https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/resources/guide-to-new-zealand-workplaces>

True or false?

Kiwis nearly always
address superiors by
their first names



The management
style in NZ is
usually very formal



You will be treated with more
respect at work if you have had
a very successful career in the
past



If you're unsure about your
job, it's better not to ask for
clarification and just get on
with it



It's expected that I will
contribute my ideas
and feedback



Managers in NZ are
seen as 'one of the
team'



Socialising at work is
viewed as time
wasting



Skills & attributes NZ employers seek



Adaptability

Communication
skills

Curiosity

Critical thinking

Customer
focussed

Teamwork

Collaboration

Problem solving



Develop networks



Importance of building networks in NZ

Small to medium
organisations

Because so many of New Zealand businesses are SME's, employers and employees are often in close contact

Hire on trust

This is why when hiring, most employers, prefer to do so through their networks — looking for people they can trust

Hidden job
market

Developing your networks is a great way to find out about jobs in the 'hidden job market' as well as develop important employability skills

Develop networks & employability skills

AUT Clubs

AUT
Employability
& Career
events

AUT peers,
staff and
students

Meetup.com

Hobbies &
interests

Toastmasters

Online
networking
(LinkedIn)



Gain NZ work experience

Benefits of local work experience

NZ employers are more likely to employ candidates who have some local work experience because:



They have an NZ
based referee



They understand the
NZ workplace culture



They have
developed
professional skills

NZ employers value both paid and volunteer experience – so consider both!

Gaining volunteer work experience

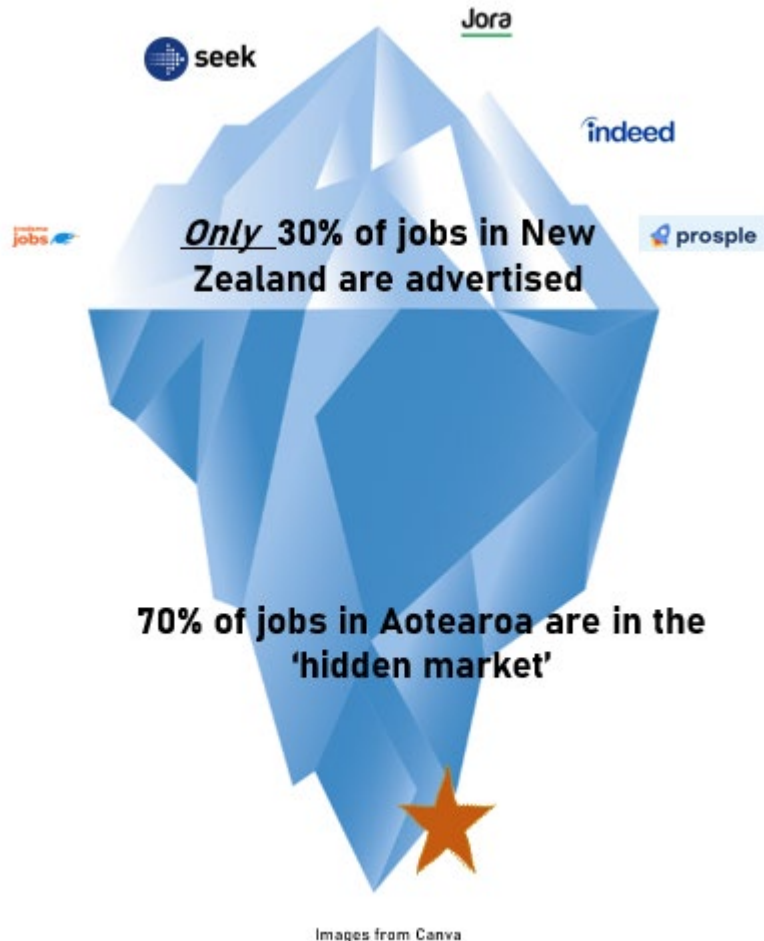


- NZ employers value volunteer work just as much as paid work experience
- This is a great way to build networks, gain skills and get some local experience as well as an NZ based referee!

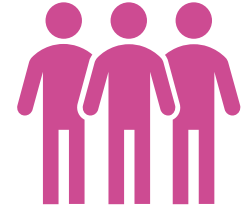
Gaining paid work through advertised roles



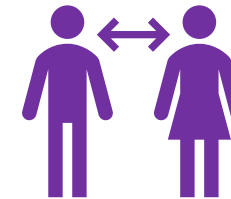
Gaining paid work experience proactively



Through professional networks



Through personal networks



Contacting organisations directly (phone, email, LinkedIn, walk in)

Join our **job search and networking** workshop to learn more



Next steps

Developing your employability

To be successful in gaining employment in NZ you'll also need to:

Have a professional NZ specific CV and cover letter

- 👉 Book a CV and cover letter workshop and / or a one-to-one appointment on elab.aut.ac.nz

Complete a professional LinkedIn profile

- 👉 Book a LinkedIn workshop and / or a one-to-one LinkedIn check appointment or use the LinkedIn dropbox on elab.aut.ac.nz

Understand the NZ interview process

- 👉 Book into a job interviews workshop, a job interview practice appointment and use the interview360 tool

Understand NZ salaries and how to negotiate

- 👉 Discuss resources and salary negotiation strategies in a one-to-one appointment, bookable on elab.aut.ac.nz

Understand your visa & working rights in NZ

- Ensure you understand your visa and the restrictions in place around working whilst you study – always check this information directly with New Zealand Immigration:
<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/new-zealand-visas>
- Understand your working rights (e.g. minimum wage) and your rights as a migrant employee – refer to www.employment.govt.nz to access the most up to date information



Questions?

RESOURCES & FURTHER READING

- AUT International student support: www.aut.ac.nz/international/international-student-support
- Immigration NZ: <https://www.immigration.govt.nz/>
- Nau Mai NZ: www.naumainz.studywithnewzealand.govt.nz
- Careers NZ: www.careers.govt.nz
- Live and Work New Zealand: www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/work-in-new-zealand
- Employment New Zealand: <https://www.employment.govt.nz/>
- Guide to NZ workplaces: <https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/resources/guide-to-new-zealand-workplaces>
- NZ workplace customs: <https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/live-in-new-zealand/tips-for-settling-in/customs-communication#section%E2%80%9445>

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